

Figure 1: Gedit with Telugu UI



Figure 2: Gedit Help in English

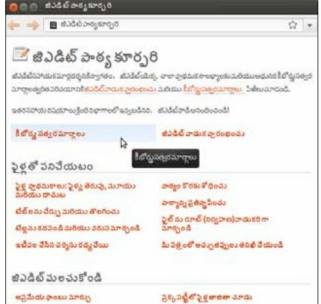


Figure 3: Gedit Help in Telugu

be large in number, it is a good practice to search for the strings in the displayed root page of the help documentation and translate them first, before going on to other pages as per the links from the root page.

Step 4: Generate the MO file from the PO file (`msgfmt -v te.po -o te.mo`)

Step 5: Generate XML files with the translated MO file as input using (`itstool -l te -m te.mo -o testte/*.*page`). If `itstool` throws up errors, please check the PO file for syntactical correctness, and use the `msgmerge` utility to merge the translated PO file with the original PO file to improve the syntax of the localised PO file

Step 6: Copy the generated mark-up files to the location used by the help system for the application (`cp -r testte /usr/share/help/te/gedit`). Update the figures with those corresponding to the target locale.

Step 7: View the help in the GNOME Help browser (`yelp /usr/share/help/te/gedit`), or launch the application and verify the quality of the translation.

Step 7: If required, repeat Steps 3-7.

Step 8: Submit the updated PO file as a comment to the Web-based GNOME documentation page for Gedit (eg: <http://l10n.gnome.org/vertimus/gedit/gnome-3-4/help/te>)

Figure 3 shows the help localised into Telugu.

We have explained the structure of the help files and

illustrated the steps for localisation using Gedit as an example, which uses Mallard for online help. Help/User manual localisation needs to be completed soon after UI localisation to increase adoption of native language computing environments by users. **END**

### For more information

- [1] How to write a manual for a GNOME application with DocBook—Manual Rego Casanovas, [http://people.igalia.com/mrego/msw/ils/how\\_to\\_write\\_a\\_manual\\_for\\_a\\_gnome\\_application\\_using\\_docbook.html](http://people.igalia.com/mrego/msw/ils/how_to_write_a_manual_for_a_gnome_application_using_docbook.html)
- [2] The Mallard website, <http://projectmallard.org/>
- [3] The Itstool website, <http://itstool.org/>
- [4] Gedit documentation links on the Gnome Mallard page <https://live.gnome.org/DocumentationProject/Tasks/ApplicationHelp>

### By: Arjuna Rao Chavala

The author is an independent consultant in the areas of IT, program/engineering management and open source. He is also the president of Wikimedia India and the WG Chair for the IEEE-SA Project P1908.1, "Virtual keyboard standard for Indic languages". He can be reached through his website <http://arjunarao.blogspot.in> and Twitter id @arjunarao.